



different development pathways," he says. Yet, both have won gold in the same stadium in Tokyo — Walcott the 2025 world title, Neeraj the Olympic one — and here Klaus does have a favourite.

"Winning the gold at the Tokyo Olympics is still my favourite medal. It's the greatest medal with the most impact on your life. It made a lot of people around me proud. I had a professor from Russia who was so excited that one of his students could coach someone to win a gold," says Klaus.

Would he ever work with Neeraj again? Despite his affection for the

Indian, Klaus doesn't see that happening. "I don't want people to speculate why I wasn't working with Neeraj. It wasn't because I had better opportunities. I just felt I was getting too old for daily coaching. It was good to work with him. It kept me physically and mentally fit, but when you're close to 80, it gets tricky.

"I don't think I'll be in a position to start coaching Neeraj again. I love him, but the responsibility is too high! With Keshorn, it's just a bit of winter assistance that grew from there. I still feel I'm retired," he says with a smile.

Next year might see Klaus in

Technical strength: "These guys are all strong, but it's not about how much you can lift or sprint. Sachin's best points are that he's both powerful and technically good" — Klaus Bartonietz.

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Scotland with Walcott for the Commonwealth Games. But for now, his schedule is full. "I'll complete my potato harvest and prepare for sowing next year. I'm going to plant all kinds — golden, red, blue ones, some Swiss and German varieties from the 1930s. It's all organic. We'll see which grows better," he says.